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Say No Like A Pro

And Gain 20 + Hours Per Week To Spend On Your Fitness, Family & Fun

10 'No's' To Double Your Ouput & Lead A Life Of Freedom, Fun And Fitness

For me, my obsession with managing time started back in 2017, when I started my personal training business. I was working full time in a secondary school as a teacher and middle leader. I was also playing for my football team, coaching a senior soccer team, doing 8 hours of private tuition, and training 6 times a week to prepare for a men's bodybuilding competition.

That was without coaching my clients, running classes, and trying to get my business off the ground so to say I had bitten off more than I could chew was an understatement, but I had to learn fast how to leverage my time and get things done.

Today, busy men across the world have a huge range of responsibilities, from being a parent to working long hours to being a loving partner and spending quality time with those that matter most.

In short...

Men today have never been under as much pressure and have never had as many things on their plate. Unfortunately, the result of all of this pressure means that a large proportion of us feel we don't have time for everything and have to let something slide, and for a lot of us, that one thing is usually our mental and physical health.

It is our mission inside Be A Better Man to teach guys how to change the narrative and not only accomplish and complete everything they want to achieve, but to create more hours to do what they want. I hope that this document provides you with a couple of 'golden nuggets' to start creating a life of freedom that includes more time and space for everything you want to do.

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3 Big Problems

You may have read or listened to people talk about 'time management,' and you might be telling yourself right now that you are really bad at 'managing time.'

This is the first problem I want you to address. You see, there is no such thing as 'time management.'

Think about it...

You can't stop time, you can't fast forward time or pause time. Therefore, time is not something that can be 'managed.'

Time is made up of seconds, minutes, and hours, and these units of time will pass by no matter what. So the first thing I want you to do is...

Change your language around how you speak about time. From now on, instead of saying 'time management,' say...'Life Management.'

As mentioned, the seconds will whiz by no matter what. It is in your power where you decide to allocate them in your life.

The second problem is understanding that in order to free up more time, you don't need to learn about any new 'time hack' or 'gimmick' that you need to add to your day. Most people who want to improve their 'life management' think about what they need to 'add' instead of 'subtract.'

For example, it is common for a guy who wants to start training in the morning to get up earlier than they normally do. Now, getting up early is not a negative thing, but my point is that the first protocol for most men is that they feel they need to 'add more' or 'do more.'

This automatically creates a level of resistance subconsciously and it is not the best approach.

This training has not been created to give you more things to do but to **show you what things to remove** from your day-to-day.

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The third problem is probably the biggest of the lot...

Your inability to say 'NO.'

I can imagine that you may be nodding your head now as you read this. Even though it is still something I have to work on, I have got so much better at this skill, and I want to share with you some of the ways and things I say 'no' to so you can plug and play them into your day-to-day.

You see, the real problem here is that you think you are missing some ritual or routine that you need to be doing. The reality is, you are probably doing things every single day that you should not be doing.

Before we dive into some practical tactics, I want to share something I heard recently...

'Most champions in sport, business and life, lack something that most ordinary people have. They lack the ability to say 'yes' to everything that comes their way.'

Let that sit for a moment.

So if you want to live a more 'championed' lifestyle, you need to master the skill of saying 'no.'

Thankfully, this guide will get you on your way.

Okay, so we have examined the problem. Let's dive into the solution.

There is one really important principle we need to examine: Understanding what a priority is and getting clear on your top 5.

A priority means that two things cannot be equally important.

When something is a priority to you, you can only focus on that one thing. No two things can be a priority at the same time.

So the first thing you need to do is make a list of your top 3-5 priorities. And before you do, make sure they are things you actually want to prioritise. Unfortunately, a lot of men can sometimes say they want to prioritise something because they feel that is what they are supposed to prioritise.

Your priorities are your priorities so OWN THEM.

So in no particular order, here are mine as of the time of writing this:

- My Business
- My Health, Fitness & Self-Care
- My Girlfriend
- My Education and Personal Development
- My Family

Now there are other things that are important in my life, like my friends, watching sports, and traveling, but right now in my life, they are not the main priorities.

This does not mean I won't spend any time in these areas, but I will only spend time here when my 'top priorities' are taken care of first.

The great thing about getting clear on your top priorities means you will now have a clear roadmap to everything in your life that you need to say 'YES' to and, more importantly, 'NO' to.

For example, if your health and fitness is on your list, and you get asked by one of your neighbours to do a school run but it will impact your morning workout, your response is...

'Sorry Sally, I can't tomorrow as I have a class I have to be at.'

Remember...'Own Your Priorities.'

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True story:

A few weeks ago, I was at a friend's wedding, and the evening before, I met up with some friends for a couple of hours. At 10 pm, the group was heading out for 'one or two drinks' and I was asked to go.

The easy thing to do was say 'sure,' but I had planned a training session the following morning that I needed to get done as I am in prep for a running event. My priority was my training session and a good night's sleep to feel fresh instead of a heavy night out.

I was clear on my priority and told the lads I would see them the following day. A few years ago, I would have worried about what the lads would have said and instead would have neglected my main priority to please them. This woud have then led to me staying out late, having one too many, sleeping in and feeling low in energy the following day.

To note, the next day, the gang that went out struggled through the next day and didn't enjoy themselves as much.

It is important to understand that saying 'no' is not easy, but it is like training a muscle in the gym. The more reps you do, the stronger it becomes.

However, if one of your priorities is your social life, that is cool, but own it.

I speak to so many guys who say they want to improve their fitness but say they don't have the time. When I dive into their days and weeks, it is not uncommon to find that they are spending 10 hours plus per week on social media (1.5 hours per day) and 3 or more hours socializing at the weekend with friends.

The fact is that socializing and social media is more of a priority than their fitness. Their daily actions are factual evidence of this.

Again, I never judge. Sometimes my role as a coach is to highlight the facts that people are not even aware of. Just be clear on your priorities and own them.

So with that, here is my 'No Playbook' with 10 examples of what I say no to and how I say no which ultimately leads to 20 + hours of 'white space' per week.

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The KMF 'No' Playbook

10 x 'Nos' That Save Me 20 Hours Of 'Whitespace' Per Week

1. Say No To Phone Calls

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 1 Hour Per Week

I wanted to start with a big one. Those who know me, know I never answer my phone unless someone has scheduled a time to speak with me. This may shock some people, but the use of my phone is for my time and no one else's.

How many times have you picked up the phone and thought, 'Aw sh#t, I'm going to be on here for ages!'

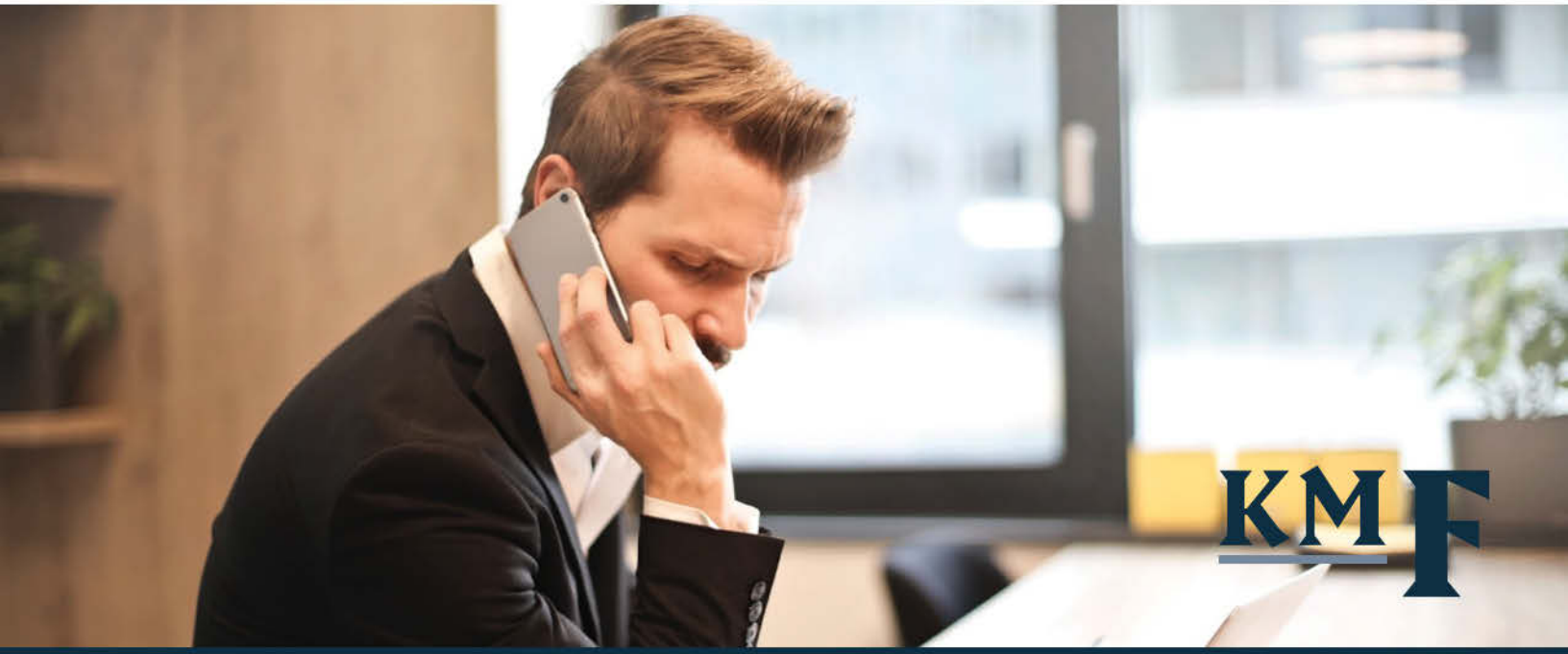
How to 'SAY NO' to answering my phone:

Well apart from the obvious of not pressing the 'accept button' something I do with my clients and my team is have set times in the week when people can book in to speak with me.

For those closest to me, they know my rule, so either I will always call them (on my chosen time) or they will text and arrange a time prior.

But what about emergencies, Kieran?

I have a 3-ring rule meaning if someone close to me rings me 3 times in short succession, then I will pick up. To note, this has never happened.



2. Say No To Late Bed Times

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 3 Hours Per Week

This is one a lot of men can struggle with. Subconsciously, most of us have a negative association with bedtimes from childhood when we were told by our parents when to go to bed. You will agree that a great day usually starts with a great morning, and a great morning starts with a good night's sleep, which means getting to bed on time.

This is just something you need to be disciplined with, and my top advice here would be to set yourself a window of time that you go to bed in.

For example, between 10 and 10.30pm.

How to 'SAY NO' to late bed times:

Create your own 30-minute night time routine which will act as a trigger to start preparing for bed. This might include preparing your work or gym clothes for the following day followed by having a bed time tea and watching a 30-minute show on Netflix. One of the best pieces of advice here is to put your phone on 'airplane mode' from 9pm or 9.30pm onwards.

3. Say No To Replying To Whatsapp Or Text Messages

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 3 Hours Per Week

Most people communicate or reply because they actually have the time to reply. Let me explain... Imagine you had 100,000 close friends, and they all messaged you on the same day, every day. Would you reply back to all of them? I hope your answer is no. The reality is you wouldn't be able to because you wouldn't have the time. So as I said above, the only reason people respond to all of their WhatsApps and texts is because they have time to do so. So what you need to start doing is creating 'less time' to respond.

How to 'SAY NO' to messages:

Set periods of times to go into your messages or WhatsApps. Dedicate 1-2 times in your day when you go on your phone just to reply to personal messages, maybe after eating lunch or dinner for a set amount of time like 20 mins. By creating dedicated times on your phone, you will be able to respond back to everyone and 'not' be constantly in and out of your messages. Another thing you can do is put your phone on airplane mode when you are replying, meaning you won't receive anything back while you respond and all of your messages will be sent at the same time giving you a little breathing space.'

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4. Say No To Mindless Sporadic Scrolling On Social Media

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 5 Hours Per Week

I don't need to tell you that social media is stealing hours of your day every day. Social media is great when used correctly, but so many of us don't use it that way. Very few men have **boundaries** around it, which is where the main problem is.

We need to protect ourselves as much as possible here because we are competing against companies who spend millions each week to keep our attention on their platforms.

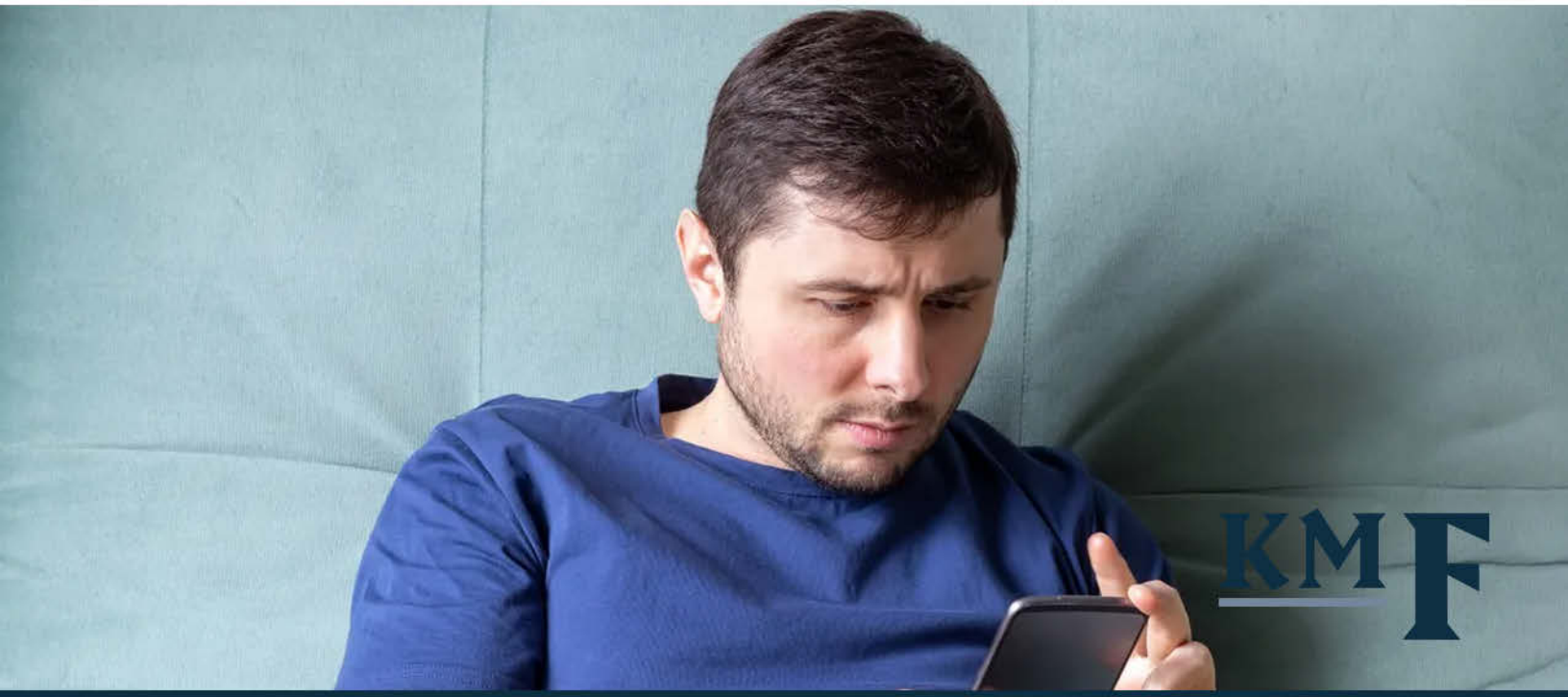
It is a David versus Goliath battle, and unless you have a strategy to manage it or delete your apps completely, you will struggle.

I would regard myself as pretty good in this area, especially as I have to go on social media for work, and there are two things that help me say no to this mindless scrolling

How to 'SAY NO' to social media:

Having set times that I 'log in' which are 2pm after lunch and 8 pm after dinner, both for a period of 20 minutes. This creates a set boundary or 'rule' that forces me to be disciplined with my use.

Hiding apps in a 'Social Media Folder' is another strategy that helps as it forces me to think for 5 seconds as I find the folder. One of the main reasons we end up on social media is because clicking on an app has become a default habit when we are bored. By creating a slight delay, it forces us to pause and think for a moment.



5. Say No To Hours Cooking Meals Or Cleaning

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 3 Hours Per Week

Okay, this is especially for anyone who runs their own business or is very busy with work and currently cooks or prepares all of their own food. If this is you, take a moment to calculate how much time you spend creating and cleaning up after your 2-3 meals per day.

I'm talking about everything from prepping, cooking, and cleaning. The reality is when you add up all daily meals, you are probably looking at close to 1 hour per day.

That's 5 hours per week, Monday to Friday!

The reason we don't acknowledge this time is because it takes place in small 15-20 minute chunks that don't seem like much in the short term, but when combined, it's a bigger monster.

Just think what you could do with 5 additional hours per week.

How to 'SAY NO' to cooking and cleaning

Here are some options to say no to cooking and cleaning:

-Invest in a meal prep company.
-Buy foods that are pre-cooked like cooked chickens.
-Order food on a delivery app.
-Buy lunches and dinners that can be cooked in the oven.
-Buy more foods that are ready-made like yogurts and smoothies.
-Invest in a dishwasher.
-Use paper plates.

Now, you might enjoy cooking, and that's great, but if your hobbies are not on your priority list, then you need to say no to at least some of it.

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BONUS: CLAIM YOUR FREE COPY OF '5 MINUTE MEALS' BY SENDING ME A MESSAGE WITH '5 MIN MEALS' ON SOCIAL MEDIA.

6. Say No To Taking Longer Than Needed To Complete A Task

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 1 Hour

Have you ever gone to the gym and you know you only have 20 minutes to train because you have somewhere to be and you can't be late?

You know those sessions that you are constantly looking at your watch as you know you need to just get in there and smash out what needs to get done?

This is an example of 'Parkinson's Law' at play which is a universal law that states that any task will take as long you give it.

To demonstrate this further, I will use tidying your house as another example.

Imagine every Saturday morning, you spend two hours tidying your house. You do everything that needs doing at a leisurely pace and it is quite relaxing.

Now imagine, you had guests visiting and you slept in for an extra 90 minutes. You wake up and you only have 30 mins to do the same task! You are in a panic and you tear around the place like a lunatic, scrubbing, hovering, mopping and tidying...

30 minutes whizz by...

You look around and you realise...

You have cleaned the place spotless.

The lesson here is that most of us will use up the time we give to tasks whether we need the time or not.

If you give yourself two hours to clean, it will take two hours. Give yourself 30 minutes and it will take 30 minutes.

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So to hack this system, you can put yourself under time constraints to get more work done in less time. This does two things:

The first is that you become more focused on the task at had.

The second is that you ignore any distractions that may slow you down.

If you get good at using this principle across your week, you will save yourself hours!

How to 'SAY NO' to taking longer than necessary for any task:

One of the best ways I accomplish this in any area of my life is by putting myself on a timer that counts down. This automatically puts me in a focused state and I know I have to get in, get the work done and then get out. For example, right now I have a timer on as I write this in a coffee shop. I gave myself 90 mins of writing today and I have 3 mins and 43 seconds left!

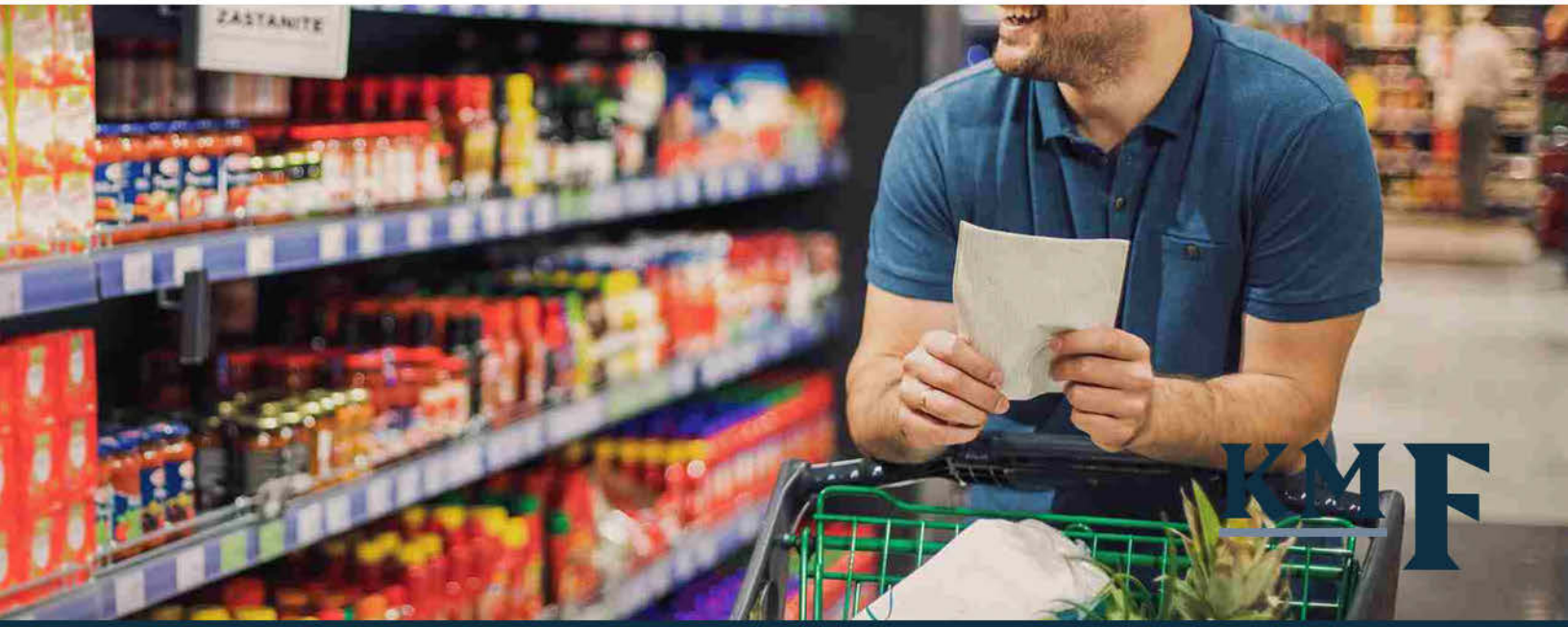
7. Say 'No' To Food Shopping

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 1 Hour

Now, if you live in the back end of nowhere, this one may not be applicable, however the majority of you reading this who do your own weekly food shop need to try this at least once and then see how good this is.

Let me share a story of when I made this switch...

I was actually forced into doing this when I moved to the UK and for the first time in my life, did not own a car. The reality was, I worked from home every day, lived beside a train station and saw how much I was going to have to pay for parking. No car needed thank you.



Anyway, when it came to getting my food in my first week, I went in search for the nearest supermarket which was about 1.5 kilometres away. That was all good until I was bringing everything home in 4 shopping bags. My arms and shoulders were broke up after that trip that took me about an hour. I knew I had to change tactics.

I honestly cannot remember now the last time I did a weekly food shop.

How to 'SAY NO' to doing a food shop in a supermarket.

Today, my girlfriend and I do our food shop online and order food that lasts for two weeks. We freeze a good bit and go to the shop around the corner when we run out of certain things like milk or fruit.

Note, if you have a partner who does the shopping then great, this strategy doesn't apply to you either. However, make sure you make it up to them for doing this by buying flowers or taking them out for dinner once in a while.

8. Say No To Snoozing The Alarm Clock

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 1 Hour

This one needs no introduction. We are all guilty of struggling a bit with this. But I want you to do a quick calculation right now. Say you are someone who snoozes their alarm for 10 -15 minutes every morning.

Multiply that time by 5 days...

Now you have just lost one hour of your week.

Multiply that across your month and you will be closer to 5 hours...

Multiply that across your year and you end up with a full 60 hours lost! 60 hours is the equivalent of 5 full days! Imagine what you could achieve with an additional 60 hours a year?

So to help with saying 'no' to the snooze button there are two things I would do...

How to 'SAY NO' to snoozing the alarm clock.

1) Go to bed a little earlier so you won't want the sleep as bad (easier said than done)

2) Put your alarm of choice out of reach, meaning it will force you to get out of bed to turn it off. You see the hardest part of actually getting up is the movement out of bed. This technique is a game changer.

9. Say No To Traffic And Queuing

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 2 Hours

I don't know about you but one of my biggest pet peeves is being stuck in a que or stuck in traffic. As I mentioned earlier, I am a little obsessed with being efficient and productive so being stuck somewhere and not moving forward is something that drives me a little mad.

Side note: I like to turn my travel time into a 'library on wheels' so I will always have a good audio book or podcast handy to listen to if I do get stuck unexpectedly.

Now this won't resonate with everyone as some of you will work from home, plus you cannot always predict when traffic is going to hit, however if bad traffic is something that is part of your week or you find yourself in places that are busy all of the time, try some of the following strategies:

How to 'SAY NO' to being stuck in traffic or long queues.

Travel to your end location (work, gym, event) before the heavy traffic starts. For example, instead of going to your gym first thing and then going to work when everyone else is, join a gym closer to your work place and drive there earlier in the morning missing the traffic.

Do your shopping at non peak times.

Do your fitness training at non peak times.

Go to the barber at the start or middle of the week and not the end.

10. Say No To Spending Time Deciding On What To Watch

Weekly Time Saved: Approx 1 Hour

Picture the scene. It's 9pm and you settle in for the evening with your other half and the challenge is posed...

'You can pick something to watch darling.'

The quest to find the perfect show begins and will usually go one or two ways...

The first way, if you are incredibly lucky, is that you will come across something that you both like inside five minutes.

However the second way, which has been the most common in my world, ends up with us scrolling through the 'recommended' and 'popular' section which has a mix of sports, reality tv, documentaries, movies and every other section under the sun.

You continue to scroll for about 15 minutes until you both decide to settle for a 30 minute episode of 'Friends' because otherwise it will be too late.

There are tens of thousands of titles on Netflix and when you log in, what you are actually seeing is what the algorithm which powers the platform has decided for you. Even though it will suggest things you're most likely to enjoy based on your viewing habits - this doesn't always hit the spot and depending how many of you use it, you will have a range of different categories set up on your profile.

So in order to say no to scrolling and driving yourself mad, there are two things I would suggest:

How to 'SAY NO' to wasting time choosing what to watch

1. Create a single account for yourself, one for your partner and one for you both as a couple or for your family. By doing so, you will be only shown shows that will be of interest to the specific account.

2. Use the 'save for later' button when you see something of interest meaning that when you are presented with the challenge again in the future, you won't have to think twice.

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The Key To Becoming A 'No Ninja'

Becoming The Man That When They Say 'Yes' They Mean It

In the world we live in today, the inflow of things we have to manage continues to increase and our demands have become even more complicated. At work, the asks are large and small, formal and informal. They are not only now from our bosses, but from our team and customers.

At home, the asks come from our other half, kids, siblings, close friends and neighbours. All day every day, most of us are receiving requests from every angle, from favours across the room to reminders in texts, from to do's in emails to appointments on phone calls and from meetings on Zoom calls to shares on social media.

To be honest fellas, it is a war zone.

Now more than ever, our professional success and personal well-being depends on our ability to manage this onslaught.

If you say 'yes' to everything and everyone you just cannot do all of it well.

Saying 'yes' to everything means you are wasting time, energy, and money and ultimately you are distracting yourself from the really important things.

None of us want to anger or disappoint our colleagues at work or turn down a request from a friend or neighbour, but those at the top of the 'life balancing' ladder know how to say both yes and no.

The key is knowing the 'right yes' and the 'right no'.

The right 'yes' puts you in a position to make a difference, help others and increase your influence.

The right 'no' protects you.

The goal is to become the guy who is known for saying no at the right times and for the right reasons.

The guy that when they say yes they mean yes.

The challenge is to get good at knowing when to make these right calls.

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So here is a three-step framework to help:

1. Rate The 'Cost' Of The Ask

Everything you do has a cost associated with it.

Either in time, energy or money.

Sometimes all three.
Before accepting the next thing you get asked to do, assess how much it will cost you and what you will need to sacrifice in order to say yes.

In order to become someone who owns their 'yes' you need to be clear on the things you value the most.

For most of us it will be:

- **Our health and self-care**
- **Our high-impact tasks at work**
- **Our quality time with loved ones**
- **Our personal hobbies**

Look at this as your **personal bank of happiness** and every yes you make is either adding to or taking from your account.

For example...

Saying yes to going for a run is depositing funds.

Saying yes to scrolling on social media is taking funds out.

2. Avoid An Immediate Response When Unsure Of The Answer.

We all want to be liked and we are all at some subconscious level worried of what others think of us. This is human nature however it can land us in 'yes quicksand' very quickly.

To overcome any request you are unsure about, the key is not to give a definite answer there and then.

Respond with a little buffer such as,

'Let me just check and I will come back to you shortly.'

Something along these lines will just give you a little breathing space to make a more informed decision.

3. Give An Effective 'Yes' or 'No'

We all respect guys who are decisive.

So when you make it clear that you can't do something and you have a valued reason for it, it will not only create more room for you to say yes to more of the things you want but it will also enhance your reputation and respect as a person.

The key when saying 'no' is to give a reason.

Researchers have shown that when hearing the word **'because'** our brain goes into an automatic behaviour of acceptance.

For example...

'Can I skip you in the queue please?' versus

'Can I skip you in the queue please because my bus is going to arrive in a few minutes?' See the difference?

Two of the same requests but the second one creates a very different feeling.

My point here is to give a reason for saying no.

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To Conclude:

As men, we have a lot to do and very little time.

Saying yes to requests at work or at home can make us feel important but can quickly become a fast road to burnout. In order to get really good at saying no in a way that makes people feel respected and say yes when we are thinking straight, you need to have a clear plan of attack.

I hope you found some of the strategies and principles in this guide useful. When you are clear on the things you should be saying 'No' to, it frees you up with so much more time for things you want to say 'Yes' to. Getting more time back in your day has nothing to do with adding more things in and has everything to do with ways to say NO more often.

My advice would be to start flexing your **'No Muscle'** bit by bit each week with things like alarm clocks, phone calls and social media and you will soon find yourself automatically declining other things that crop up to steal your valuable daily hours. Remember the only resource in life that you cannot get back is your time. Protect it at all costs.

For more strategies on productivity, work life balance or anything self care of health related, check out my following channels for daily tips:

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